

a printable investigation

Eleanor Hart Is Missing

At six, her mother set a place for supper.
At eight, a telegram said she had gone away.

Her family kept a name out of the records.
Eleanor found it.
Then Eleanor disappeared.

CINCINNATI / 19 JUNE 1912

Read the documents. Reconstruct the family.
Find what happened to Eleanor.

1-4 investigators / pencil + paper / fully offline

Start on page 2. Keep hints (27-30) and solutions (31-36) separate until needed.

READ FIRST

Read the people. Test the papers.

Print the Player PDF in full. This edition contains 30 pages, including its cover and interleaved story. Use US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%; on A4, use Fit. Grayscale is sufficient. Single-sided lets you spread the records out; duplex uses the long edge. Keep the separate hints and sealed solution away from the player stack.

Follow the printed archive folios. Existing page references mean the numbers labeled ARCHIVE in the footers, which remain stable. New story leaves use S0-S3. They make the PDF positions different from the archive numbers. Use the bookmarks or clickable catalog to find a page on screen.

Begin with the opening scene and brief. Read EH01-EH03 and choose your next record through archive folio 4. Each later scene names the records to read first. In a nonlinear search, return to that scene after you have examined its records; scene order does not prove a connection.

Let the records carry the proof. The new scenes dramatize the people around these papers. They are fictional narrative, not additional archival exhibits. A character can be mistaken. Names, dates, parents, addresses, source references, and the supplied rules establish the case; sympathy does not.

Make your case. Use archive folios 21-26. Cite exhibit codes and exact fields, test alternatives, and leave unsupported matters open. Everyone investigates; no host, internet, cutting, or outside research is required. Use hints only when needed; open the solution after answering all final questions.

The original investigation has sixteen exhibits and six final deductions.

THE STORY CONTINUES

The supper kept warm

Before the opening brief

Margaret had left the warming oven open. By morning there was nothing in it worth saving, but shutting the door seemed too much like agreeing that the meal was over.

Henry stood beside the table with his cap crushed between his hands. He was old enough to work at the works and young enough to look at his mother whenever something had to be decided. She wanted him to say something useful. Instead he asked whether she had slept.

"Have you?" she said.

He shook his head. She put a cup in front of him. It was easier to be angry while doing something kind.

The telegram lay beside Eleanor's place. Margaret had read it until the capital letters ceased to resemble her daughter's voice. Gone away. Do not look. She could imagine Eleanor going somewhere without permission. That was different from believing she had sent this message. Her daughter was twenty-five; Margaret knew she could not make a disappearance impossible merely by calling it unlike her.

"James says she went," Henry said.

"I know what James says."

He looked down. She heard what she had done: made him choose between an absent sister and the brother he would have to face at work. She touched his sleeve.

"Tell them what you know. Not what will make me feel better."

When George arrived, his expression was the careful one he used for estate business. He put his papers on the table, then moved them away from Eleanor's plate. Margaret watched that small correction. For sixteen months, since Samuel's death, George had been the person who knew what had to be signed and what could wait. This morning she needed him to admit that he might not know.

"She asked you to listen," she said.

"I intended to."

"Then start with what she left here."

George reached for the portfolio of copies. Margaret did not let go at once. Some part of her still wished Eleanor had left the old registers alone. She hated herself for the wish, and hated that it had survived the night.

Henry drew his chair closer. Nobody ate. The papers were spread between people who loved the same missing woman and no longer knew whether they could trust the same brother.

A place at the table

Wednesday, 19 June 1912 / before the family meeting

At six o'clock yesterday evening, Margaret Hart set a place for her daughter. At seven she put Eleanor's supper in the warming oven. At twelve minutes past eight, a boy brought a telegram. The message said Eleanor had gone away. Her mother did not believe it.

For a week Eleanor had been copying names from old registers. Yesterday she took a portfolio to Hart Tool & Pattern Works. She did not come home. Her father, Samuel, has been dead for sixteen months. At ten this morning his brother George is due to settle the ownership of the business. Eleanor had asked him to hear what she had found first.

Person	Place in the inquiry
Eleanor Mae Hart	Missing; 25; daughter of Samuel and Margaret.
James Hart	Her brother; acting manager of the works.
Henry Hart	Her younger brother; apprentice at the works.
George Hart	Her uncle; Samuel's brother and executor.
Margaret Hart	Her mother; reported the disappearance.

Your task: reconstruct the family, explain the disappearance, and tell George where to search. The records name other people you will need to identify for yourself.

Treat this as a closed case file: all required evidence is supplied. Statements can be mistaken or dishonest; compare them with independent records. No unseen accomplice or undisclosed fact is needed to solve the case.

Inside the file

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Work pages: family (21), timeline (22), possible explanations (23), final answers (24-25), evidence log (26).
Optional hints: 27-30. Protected solution: 31-36.

All characters, businesses and individual records are fictional. These are purpose-designed reading exhibits, not scans of authentic records. Census fields are selectively reproduced. The will is a fictional instrument. No print defect, typeface or punctuation difference is a clue.

Missing-person inquiry

Cincinnati / report opened 19 June 1912, 7.30 a.m.

Subject	Details
Name	Eleanor Mae Hart / age 25
Residence	1634 Lincoln Avenue, Walnut Hills
Destination	Hart Tool & Pattern Works / 418 Eastern Avenue

Mrs. Margaret Hart reports that her daughter left home at about 4.30 yesterday afternoon, Tuesday, 18 June. She carried a brown paper portfolio tied with blue cotton tape. She said she was taking family papers to the works and would be home for supper at six.

She wore a pale blouse, dark skirt and a straw hat with a black band. She took neither a travelling bag nor a change of clothes. A telegram was delivered at 8.12 p.m. Mrs. Hart cannot explain it and has retained the envelope.

JAMES HART / BROTHER / ACTING MANAGER

"I saw her near the front office at five. She said she was going away. She left by the river gate. I have not seen her since."

HENRY HART / BROTHER / APPRENTICE

"I was out with a delivery. Nell said she would show Uncle George something at tomorrow's meeting. She would not say what."

GEORGE HART / UNCLE / EXECUTOR

"A family meeting was arranged for ten this morning. Eleanor asked me not to settle the works before I had heard her. She sounded excited, not frightened."

Papers from Eleanor's writing desk supplied by Mrs. Hart. No conclusion as to a voluntary departure has been reached.

Household schedule

Thirteenth census / census date: 15 April 1910

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

1634 Lincoln Avenue / dwelling 47 / family 52

Name	Relation	Age	Marriage	Years
Samuel Hart	Head	56	M2	28
Margaret Hart	Wife	50	M1	28
Eleanor Hart	Daughter	23	Single	-
James Hart	Son	20	Single	-
Henry Hart	Son	15	Single	-

Name	Occupation / industry
Samuel Hart	Manufacturer / tool and pattern works
Margaret Hart	None
Eleanor Hart	None
James Hart	Machinist / tool works
Henry Hart	None; attended school

Margaret: children born, 3; children living, 3.

Samuel: home owned, mortgaged.

All five residents and their parents born Ohio.

Key: M1 = first marriage; M2 = second marriage. Years = completed years of the present marriage. A dash means the field does not apply. Selected household fields copied by Eleanor; all residents shown.

Marriage-register extracts

Hamilton County / copies made 14 June 1912

ENTRY 94 / VOLUME 31 / PAGE 94

14 September 1876

Samuel Hart, aged 22, of Cincinnati
and **Ellen Byrne**, aged 20, of Cincinnati.

Bride's father: John Byrne.

Marriage solemnized on the date above.

Entered: 16 September 1876.

ENTRY 187 / VOLUME 42 / PAGE 187

19 May 1881

Samuel Hart, aged 27, of Cincinnati
and **Margaret Cole**, aged 21, of Cincinnati.

Marriage solemnized on the date above.

Entered: 21 May 1881.

Both extracts copied on 14 June 1912.

E. M. Hart

Two extracts retained among Eleanor's family papers.

Parish register

St. Anne's Parish / Cincinnati / extracts supplied 15 June 1912

BAPTISMS / ENTRY 63

Francis Hart

Born: **3 July 1877.**

Baptized: 22 July 1877.

Father: Samuel Hart, pattern maker.

Mother: Ellen Hart, formerly Byrne.

Residence: Cincinnati.

Sponsors: Michael Byrne and Catherine Byrne.

BURIALS / ENTRY 41

Ellen Hart, formerly Byrne

Wife of Samuel Hart. Aged 23 years.

Died: **4 November 1879.**

Buried: 6 November 1879.

Survived by husband Samuel and son Francis.

Brother named in the entry: Michael Byrne, of Kilgour Street.

Supplied at the request of Miss Eleanor Hart.

A. Fenwick, parish clerk

Spare extracts retained on Eleanor's writing desk.

THE STORY CONTINUES

The first wife's name

After EH03-EH04 / Documents 03-04

Margaret read the marriage entry without moving her lips. Samuel's name was familiar enough to make the rest of the line seem a mistake.

Ellen Byrne.

There were dates she could test, a parish to ask, a child to trace. Those were the useful things. The useless thing was the sudden desire to remember every occasion on which Samuel might have told her and had not.

George waited. That irritated her more than a question would have done.

"You needn't watch me," she said. "I can read it."

"I wasn't certain you would want to."

She looked at him then. Eleanor's notebook would preserve her own awkward response to the discovery: asking whether her daughter had eaten. Margaret had meant to keep one ordinary thing from falling apart. She could see how it might have sounded like asking Eleanor to stop.

"Would wanting change the entry?"

George turned the page so the burial extract lay beside the marriage. The formal lines offered no account of what kind of wife Ellen had been. They did not say whether she laughed loudly, whether she worried over money, whether someone had sat beside her at the end. Margaret had first experienced her as an intrusion. Here was the record of her death.

She was ashamed of the order in which her feelings had arrived.

"I don't want my children made smaller by this," she said.

George did not answer quickly. "We have to find out what this is before we decide what it takes from anyone."

Margaret smoothed the edge of the copy. It had not been torn. She was smoothing something that did not need mending.

Eleanor had met the same names in the same narrow columns and kept going. For the first time that morning, her mother understood the work as more than a daughter upsetting a house. Someone had once occupied these lines. Somebody had been left to carry the memory of her.

That still did not tell Margaret whom to trust. It gave her a reason to turn the next page.

Household schedule

Tenth census / census date: 1 June 1880

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

204 Kilgour Street / dwelling 18 / family 21

Name	Relation to head	Age	Condition
Michael Byrne	Head	28	Married
Catherine Byrne	Wife	25	Married
Francis Hart	Nephew	2	Single

Name	Occupation	Born
Michael Byrne	Millwright	Ohio
Catherine Byrne	Keeping house	Ohio
Francis Hart	-	Ohio

Michael and Catherine: both parents born Ireland.

Francis: both parents born Ohio.

Copy includes all residents returned for this household.

E. M. Hart / 14 June 1912

Selected fields copied from the household schedule. Ages are as of the census date, not the date Eleanor copied the entry.

Household schedule

Twelfth census / census date: 1 June 1900

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

204 Kilgour Street / dwelling 41 / family 44

Name	Relation	Birth	Age
Michael Byrne	Head	Feb 1852	48
Catherine Byrne	Wife	Jun 1854	45
Frank Byrne	Nephew	Jul 1877	22

Name	Occupation	Marital status
Michael Byrne	Millwright	Married, 24 years
Catherine Byrne	-	Married, 24 years
Frank Byrne	Machinist	Single

Catherine: children born, 0; children living, 0.

All three residents born Ohio.

Michael and Catherine: parents born Ireland.

Frank: parents born Ohio.

House owned, free of mortgage.

Copy includes all residents returned for this household.

E. M. Hart / 14 June 1912

Selected household fields. Age is age at last birthday on the census date.

Private correspondence

Letter addressed to Samuel Hart / retained among his private papers

204 Kilgour Street
9 July 1905

Samuel,

Frank turned twenty-eight on Monday. Catherine made the seed cake he likes, though he says he is too old for birthdays.

You asked what name he uses at the shop. It is Frank Byrne, as it has been since his schooldays. In Ellen's parish book he is Francis Hart. He is the same boy you brought to us after my sister died. A different name did not give him a different father.

He knows who you are. I have never told him otherwise. He has asked why you can pass him in the street and inquire after his work, yet never ask him into your house.

I cannot answer that for you. Your younger children are not to blame for knowing nothing of him. Neither is Frank to blame for being born before them.

Your money has arrived each quarter. I have kept the receipts, as you requested. But he earns his own living now. If there is something you wish him to have, put it plainly in writing and tell him yourself.

Michael

Estate of Samuel Hart

Will extract and executor's memorandum

Will dated: 2 November 1909.

Samuel Hart died: 14 February 1911.

Will admitted to probate: 21 March 1911.

Executor: George Hart, brother of the deceased.

EXTRACT / THE WORKS

"I give my interest in Hart Tool & Pattern Works, together with its machinery, tools, patterns, stock and goodwill, to my eldest surviving son. This gift is not conditional upon his present employment in the works or residence in my household. Until delivery of the business to that son, my executor shall retain its control."

MEMORANDUM / 17 JUNE 1912

James manages the works under my temporary authority. The works have not yet been distributed. Samuel told me years ago that the child of his first marriage had died. I had understood James to be the eldest surviving son and prepared an acknowledgment of delivery on that basis.

Eleanor has asked that no delivery be made before she is heard. I have arranged for the family to meet here at ten on Wednesday, 19 June. I shall examine what she brings before proceeding. Her copies of the family records are to be checked against the originals.

G. Hart / Executor

The case asks you to interpret the words of this fictional will using the supplied family records. No external inheritance rules are required.

THE STORY CONTINUES

What the payments could not buy

After EH07-EH08 / Documents 07-08

Henry stopped at the seed cake. Of all the things in Michael Byrne's letter, that was the detail he read twice.

"Twenty-eight," he said. "And she still made it."

Margaret knew what he was trying to imagine. A birthday in a house none of them had visited. A man who could be passed in the street and asked about his work. A father's money arriving on time while the invitation never arrived at all.

"We weren't told," Henry said.

"No."

He seemed to need more than that. She could not give him innocence on behalf of every adult in the family. She could only leave room for the question.

George laid his executor's memorandum beside the letter. Its orderly sentences looked different now. He had written down what Samuel told him; he had prepared to act upon it. Whatever the investigation ultimately established, repeating a trusted man's account had not made the account independent evidence.

"James has been doing the work," Henry said. He sounded almost apologetic. "That part is true."

"It may be," George said. "The gift has words of its own."

Margaret disliked the coldness of that answer until she considered its alternative: each of them editing the will to reward the person already nearest to them. James's work did not vanish because another record existed. Neither could another person be made to vanish because James's work mattered.

Michael's letter did not ask the younger children to apologize for being born. It asked Samuel to do something plain. Tell him yourself. Margaret found the simplicity of it unbearable.

Henry moved the letter out from under the estate paper.

"Don't cover it," he said.

She left it where he put it. They still needed the records that connected one name to another, and evidence that reached the present day. Affection was not a certificate. But the certificates were no longer an exercise in tidying a pedigree. Whatever name the investigation established, there was a person at the other end who had once waited to be asked inside.

Eleanor's notebook

17-18 June 1912 / retained on her writing desk

MONDAY / 17 JUNE

Uncle George will wait until Wednesday. He says names on a family tree are not enough: bring the papers that connect them.

Mother does not remember ever hearing Ellen's name. She looked at the marriage copy for a long time, then asked whether I had eaten.

I mean to write to Mr. Byrne when I know how to begin. What does one say to a person who has been kept outside one's life for twenty-five years?

TUESDAY / 18 JUNE / BEFORE LEAVING

James called at four. He says Father's old receipt book is still downstairs at the works, beside the pearwood patterns. It may show the payments Michael mentioned. He will meet me at the front office at five and fetch it with me.

He was very particular that I should come alone. He says Mother has been upset enough.

Take the copies, not Michael's letter. Leave this book here. Home for supper at six. Tomorrow I shall put the whole thing before George, even if James thinks it unkind.

A name ought not to be a thing a family can take away.

Bell & Mercer

Private lending / correspondence retained at the works

15 JUNE 1912 / TO MR. JAMES HART

Sir,

Your personal advance of **\$1,200** falls due on **20 June**. You represented that the works would shortly be delivered to you from your father's estate.

We have received no evidence of that delivery. Unless the executor confirms your ownership, we will require repayment in money. Your position as acting manager does not satisfy our request.

W. Mercer

REPLY RETAINED / 17 JUNE 1912

Mr. Mercer,

The acknowledgment is prepared for Wednesday morning. I expect to have it in hand before noon. You shall receive it that day. I cannot repay the advance in cash.

James Hart

Personal correspondence. The advance is James's private debt.

THE STORY CONTINUES

A reason is not a permission

After EH09-EH10 / Documents 09-10

The amount in the lender's letter drew Henry's eye before anything else. He had never held twelve hundred dollars. Written beside the due date, it made James's confidence about Wednesday look less like confidence.

"He must have thought he could put it right," Henry said.

Margaret heard an old family habit in the sentence: take the frightening thing, find a gentler name for it, and hope the new name will hold.

"We don't know what he did," she answered.

Henry looked relieved. She made herself finish.

"That means we must find out. It doesn't mean we may stop."

George read Eleanor's notebook again. She had intended to bring copies, protect the original letter, go home for supper, and put the matter before him. Even in private she was thinking about what papers would survive being carried through the works. Her care was practical. She had not known she would need someone else to follow it.

Margaret paused at the words about James thinking it unkind. She knew how effective that accusation could be inside a family. Cruelty sounded like shouting. Unkindness could be laid at the feet of the quiet person asking a question.

"I wanted her to leave it for a day," she said. "I wanted one supper without these names in it."

Neither man offered to absolve her. For once she was grateful. There was a difference between wishing a daughter would stop asking and making her unable to speak. There was also work to do before anyone could say what had happened at the works.

George drew the attendance reply and office records toward him. They had been made for different purposes by people with different things to notice. A debt could explain pressure. A frightened family could supply a theory. Neither could place a man at a particular door.

Henry opened his hands and let the cap rest on the table. "Then we follow it all the way," he said.

Margaret nodded. She wanted Eleanor home. She was beginning to understand that she could not make that wish conditional on what bringing her home might reveal.

Attendance reply

Ohio Valley Machinists Association / annual meeting / Pittsburgh

TUESDAY / 18 JUNE 1912

Afternoon practical examination / Room B

Delegate	Town	Entered	Released
Charles R. Nolan	Louisville	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.
Frank Byrne	Cincinnati	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.
Arthur M. Keene	Pittsburgh	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.

Each man worked at his assigned bench throughout the examination. No delegate left the room between the times entered above. I called the roll at the opening and close and supervised the benches throughout.

Frank Byrne gave his home address as **204 Kilgour Street, Cincinnati**. His signature appears on the original attendance leaf.

I attest to his presence during the whole interval, not merely to his registration for the meeting.

Thomas W. Reed

Examination steward

Reply received by George Hart at 8.05 a.m., 19 June 1912. For this reply, **all attendance times above are stated in Cincinnati time**. Signed original to follow by post.

Works office book

Hart Tool & Pattern Works / 18-19 June 1912

Key	Issued to	Out	Returned
A3 / front office	Ada Pike	8.00 a.m.	6.30 p.m.
B2 / counting room	George Hart	4.45 p.m.	6.20 p.m.
C7 / lower store	James Hart	4.50 p.m.	Not returned

Private message accounts

J17 / James Hart

G04 / George Hart

H09 / Henry Hart

These charges are paid by the named person, not the works.

CLERK'S MEMORANDUM / 19 JUNE, 7.50 A.M.

I balanced the estate accounts with Mr. George Hart in the counting room from 4.50 until 6.10 yesterday. He remained with me throughout. I saw him return B2 at 6.20.

Henry Hart returned the signed delivery receipt from Larkin's yard. Their receiving clerk records that Henry was helping him unload continuously from 4.45 until 5.45 p.m. The original receipt is attached to the office book.

C7 has not been returned. Its duplicate is still in the sealed envelope in the cash box; I checked it this morning. The seal bears my initials and has not been broken since I sealed it on **11 June, after the replacement lock was fitted.**

Ada Pike

Statement of Thomas Vale

Watchman / statement taken 19 June 1912, 8.12 a.m.

At ten past five yesterday I was in the passage by the lower stair. A young woman in a straw hat with a black band came through carrying a brown packet tied with blue tape. I saw her go down with a man from the office. I saw his back and cannot swear who he was.

At about twenty past five Mr. James Hart came up those stairs alone. I know him well. He told me the young lady had gone out by the river gate. He said the lower store was empty and I need not try its door on my rounds.

I heard three knocks from below at half past six. When I stopped, they came again. I took them for a loose pipe and went on. I did not see the young lady leave the building.

At ten minutes past eight this morning I heard the same knocking. No machinery was running. I went down and found the lower door locked. I could get no words through it. I asked Miss Pike for C7 and learned it was still out.

I should have tried the door last night. Mr. Hart had told me there was no one there.

Thomas Vale

Statement recorded at the works. The witness distinguishes the man he recognized from the man whose face he did not see.

River & City Telegraph

Delivered message and local dispatch memorandum

Accepted: Cincinnati office / 18 June 1912 / 7.48 p.m.

Delivered: 8.12 p.m.

To: Mrs. Margaret Hart / 1634 Lincoln Avenue / Cincinnati

GONE TO DAYTON FOR A FEW DAYS
DO NOT LOOK FOR ME
WILL WRITE
ELEANOR

DISPATCH MEMORANDUM / SUPPLIED 19 JUNE

The message was brought in an envelope by a works messenger. He did not claim to be Miss Hart. The signature in the message was copied as supplied; we did not see the person whose name it bore.

Charge instruction enclosed: **Hart works private account J17.**

Receipt 4186. Fee entered against J17.

PAUL FINCH / MESSENGER

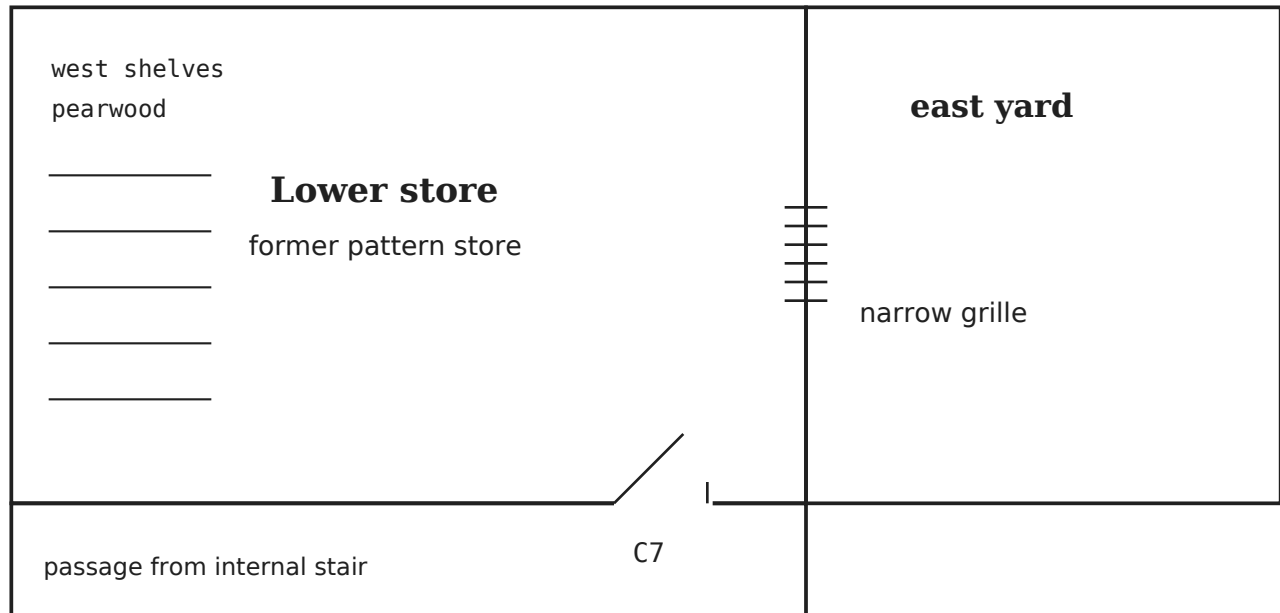
"Mr. James Hart handed me the envelope at the works at half past seven. He told me to have it sent at once and put the charge on his own account. I took it directly to the office without opening it."

Recorded by A. Ellis, telegraph clerk.

The telegram was accepted in Cincinnati; it was not received from a Dayton office.

Lower-floor survey

418 Eastern Avenue / 11 June 1912 / not to scale



north is above / east is right

SERVICE NOTE / C7

Lower store, formerly pattern store. Pearwood patterns remain on the west shelves. Door reached only by the internal stair and passage. The river gate is on the main floor; there is no passage from this room to that gate.

Fitted replacement outside lock. Key marked C7, with one duplicate. No other key supplied. There is no inside handle or release. Door must be locked with the key; it does not lock merely by closing.

Ventilation opening to yard retained. Narrow grille admits air and small papers, not a person. Opening can be reached from the shelves. No window or other exit from the store.

R. Moss / Locksmith

East-yard recovery

19 June 1912 / 8.15 a.m. / works yard

Watchman Vale found this folded paper beneath a low grille in the east yard wall. Its reverse is a receipted invoice from the works. Mrs. Hart identifies the writing as Eleanor's. The pencil strokes are heavy; the last line is deeply scored into the paper.

As the paper was handed to the officer, Miss Pike was bringing the sealed duplicate key from the office. George Hart waited at the head of the lower stair. The door had not yet been opened.

TEXT OF THE NOTE

If this comes out where someone can see it, please fetch Uncle George.

I was brought down for Father's book. The door was locked while I was looking at the shelves. It was done with the key. I heard it turn.

I have been here all night. I can see morning through the narrow opening. There is paper here and a carpenter's pencil. I have been knocking, but the machines stopped long ago and nobody comes.

He said I should come out when the acknowledgment was signed. Do not let George sign it.

Eleanor

Please do not let him sign it.

Reconstruct the family

Use solid lines for proven links and dotted lines for working theories.

A family reconstruction diagram template. At the top is a box labeled 'shared parent' with a horizontal line below it. A vertical line descends from this box and splits into two horizontal lines. Below each horizontal line is a box. The left box is labeled 'first spouse / marriage date' and the right box is labeled 'later spouse / marriage date'. Both boxes have a horizontal line below them. From the bottom of the left box, a vertical line descends to another box labeled 'child / name later used'. From the bottom of the right box, a vertical line descends to a box labeled 'children / ages or dates'. Both of these bottom boxes have a horizontal line below them.

WHO RAISED THE CHILD?

Name the adults and explain how they were related to the child.

Which exhibits prove that the two names belong to one person?

Follow the last afternoon

Write the event, its source, and whether it is witnessed, reported or inferred.

Date / time	Event or whereabouts	Exhibit
18 June / before five		
5.00-5.10 p.m.		
5.10-5.20 p.m.		
6.10-6.30 p.m.		
7.30-8.12 p.m.		
19 June / morning		
Next action		

A person's own claim is not independent confirmation. Attendance times in EH11 have already been converted to Cincinnati time.

Test competing explanations

Motive alone is not a case. Record evidence for and against each explanation.

Person / theory	Reason or access	Evidence against / unresolved
James Hart		
Henry Hart		
George Hart		
Another person named in the records		
Eleanor left voluntarily		

Which explanation accounts for the family papers, the appointment, the locked door and the telegram together?

Your final reconstruction

Answer in your own words. Give exhibit codes for every conclusion.

01

The family before Margaret

Who was Samuel's first wife? Who was their child? Cite the record that proves parentage.

02

The name that changed

Who is Frank Byrne, and how is he related to Eleanor? Connect the 1880 child to the 1900 adult and the person documented in 1912.

03

The ownership of the works

Who fits the beneficiary description in the will? Why must George stop the prepared acknowledgment?

Your final reconstruction

Your answer must explain the evidence, not merely name a suspect.

04

The disappearance

Who is responsible, why act now, and how was Eleanor confined? Include her plans and at least one independent record of access or conduct.

05

The telegram

Who arranged it? What does the dispatch record prove, and what does the signature fail to prove?

06

The search instruction

Give the address, room, route and key. Explain why the door could not simply lock itself and what supports searching for Eleanor alive.

Keep a useful detail separate from the conclusion you draw from it.

Finish all six answers before opening the solution. If you are stuck, turn only to the hint section and cover the hints you do not need.